



SIPRA DAS

DELETED CHAPTER: Lalu is out of school textbooks Minister Brishan Patel. He adds that the removal of the chapter is not a political decision.

Patel insists that Lalu is not a historical figure, and what he has ordered is aimed at correcting a historical wrong. "Lalu is not a model for school students. Including him in the curriculum with other legends cannot be justified," he says. According to him, a story on Dalit activist Jyotiba Phule will replace Lalu's chapter.

The decision to remove the chapter on Lalu was taken immediately after Kumar assumed office in 2005. But it took two years to be deleted because the bureaucrats who were assigned to the job were reluctant.

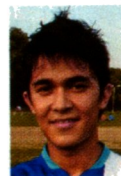
But Narayan is not the solitary man to have penned Lalu's eulogies. There are also *Laloo Prasad: Rags to Regime* and *Lalu Chalisa* in his honour. But for now, the former chief minister seems to have fallen out of the good books of the state Government.

by Amitabh Srivastava

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: Teji Bachchan, 93, actor Amitabh Bachchan's mother and wife of late Hindi poet Harivansh Rai Bachchan. She had been ailing for a year.

CONFERRED: On Sunil Chettri, All India Football



Federation's Player of the Year award. He was the highest Indian goalscorer in the 11th edition of the National Football League.

WON: By Vidit Gujrati, the Parsvnath National Under-13 Chess Championship, beating Pranav Shetty. He remained unbeaten throughout the tournament.

SELECTED: Ghulam Mohammad for this year's Sangeet Natak Academy award for his contribution towards Dogri and Gojri music in Jammu and Kashmir.

DIED: Former Arunachal Pradesh Congress MP Wangcha Rajkumar. He was shot dead by unidentified assailants.

No More Lessons

PATNA Union Railways Minister Lalu Prasad Yadav may still personify an idea that charms top business schools the world over, but his luck has run out back home in Bihar. He is now on his way out of the school syllabus.

The Nitish Kumar Government has decided to delete Lalu from school textbooks. The chapter, titled *Mitti ke Gaurav*, has been part of *Gadya Sopan*, a Hindi textbook prescribed for Class VIII students since the '90s. It was authored by Harivansh Narayan, a Bihar

joint secretary-rank officer in the Animal Husbandry Department, who has been suspended for other administrative reasons. The Election Commission had also prevented Narayan from poll duty during the 2005 assembly elections following objections from some political parties.

The revised book will be available during the 2008 academic session. "There is nothing for children to learn from Lalu's life. He did nothing to inspire anyone," says Bihar Human Resource

VIS-A-VIS ANBUMANI RAMADOSS Union health minister **versus** RAJIV PRATAP RUDY BJP spokesperson

A doctor from Bihar was the singular cause for Great Britain derecognising MBBS degrees.



SAURABH SINGH

This is an insane remark from the health minister. He specifically targeted a doctor from Bihar, calling him a 'Bihari doctor'.

EPILOGUE: From Britain to Bihar, politics takes an unhealthy turn.